

08-13-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s3FSxHgH0tg
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Target Category	mcs

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Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Trustees Meeting Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:04:51](#) The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees was called to order by the presiding officer. The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Hafer, Mr. Spees, Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Low, Mr. Irvan.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Clearly identified as leading the roll call and proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance 00:04:51. Dr. Reynolds was also recognized for his birthday during the meeting 00:10:47.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard procedural progression).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:16:32 Consent Agenda Items & Personnel Changes**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board noted the retirement of Donna New (Building Aide at Grissom Elementary School) and an adjustment to the consent agenda regarding Laura Norris (who rescinded her resignation as a speech-language pathologist at Longfellow and moved to part-time status).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:17:46.
- **00:17:56 Permission to Advertise the 2025 Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Business Manager / Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented a comprehensive 20-slide presentation detailing the 2025 school budget timetable (public hearing scheduled for August 27th, budget adoption on September 10th). Key figures included:
 - Education Fund: Advertising \$44.1 million in spending for 2025 (supported by state basic grants tied to flat enrollment projections, with a cash balance projected over \$15 million). Textbook rental funds will be rolled into the education fund starting January 1, 2025 (\$160 per ADM count received directly from the state).
 - Operation Fund: Budgeting approximately \$11.6 to \$11.7 million in appropriations, heavily impacted by Muncie's constitutional property tax caps (which result in over \$11.5 million uncollected). Offsets continue to rely on transfers (up to the 15% statutory limit from the education fund) and rainy day fund balances.
 - Debt Service Fund: Total outstanding debt has decreased to \$21.6 million (down from a high of \$38.5 million in 2018). The \$12 million state loan is being paid down (projected down to \$7.9 million by the end of December) and will be fully paid off by June 2028.
 - Total Advertised Budget: Approximately \$70.3 million across all funds (including rainy day appropriations).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [06:4:20].
 - **01:03:00 Emergency Repair Authorization: Westview Elementary Piping**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration reported an emergency water leak caused by corroded 4-in dual-pipe heating/cooling lines in the ceiling of a south hallway at Westview Elementary. Because the failure occurred immediately prior to the start of school, emergency purchase orders were authorized (not to exceed \$400,000). Thanks to swift work by contractors (Resolve Tech, Houston Electric, and Pride Mark), the repairs were completed prior to the start of school on August 7th at an actual cost of approximately \$280,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:07:23](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public addressed the board during the open public comment period.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **School Year Kickoff & Enrollment:** Dr. Reynolds reported a smooth start to the school year, noting successful faculty kickoff events, high teacher retention/early hiring (over 40 new teachers onboarded), and enthusiastic student attendance. Elementary transportation, parking lot dismissal, and bus/yellow bus routes are stabilizing.
 - **Band Success:** The marching band was celebrated as State Fair Band Day Champions with an undefeated season and top honors in music, marching, and effect.
 - **Facility Projects:** The high school locker room project, concession stand, team meeting room, and restrooms are nearing completion with electricity secured in time for the first home football game on August 23rd (which will feature an "Alumni Educator Recognition Ceremony").
 - **Cell Phone Policy:** The board noted that national educational media highlights Muncie's early adoption of strict cell phone policies, reporting positive anecdotal compliance from students.
 - **Future Meetings:** Public hearing for the 2025 budget is set for August 27th; budget adoption is set for September 10th. A work session regarding a 5-year operational fund look-ahead is scheduled for October 22nd.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [01:16:08](#).
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